



EDWARD B. GRIMBALL, Chairman
C. CURTIS HUTTO
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SOUTH CAROLINA REVENUE AND FISCAL AFFAIRS OFFICE

FRANK A. RAINWATER
Executive Director

May 1, 2026

By Electronic Filing

Ms. Marlene H. Dortch
Secretary
Federal Communications Commission
45 L Street, N.E.
Washington, DC 20554

Re: Notice of Ex Parte Presentation
Facilitating Implementation of Next Generation 911 Services,
PS Docket No. 21-479

Dear Ms. Dortch:

On April 30, 2026, Paul Michael Athey David Morrison, Michael Ball, and Kasey Hamrick of the South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office ("RFA"), the 911 authority for the state of South Carolina, together with Susan Ornstein from the Allerium business segment of Comtech Telecommunications Corp., met with David Furth, Rachel Waxman, John Evanoff, Rasoul Safavian, Thomas Eng, Daniel Spurlock and Alison Venable from the Federal Communication Commission's Public Safety and Homeland Security Bureau to update the Commission on the status of the NG911 deployment in South Carolina and the continuing nature of extra costs incurred by South Carolina. For the reasons explained below, RFA urges the Federal Communications Commission ("FCC" or "Commission") to promptly enforce the rules adopted in the NG911 Transition Report and Order.¹

¹ Facilitating Implementation of Next Generation 911 Services (NG911); Location-Based Routing for 911 Calls, PS Docket Nos. 21-479 and 18-64, Report and Order, 39 FCC Rcd 8137 (July 19, 2024) ("NG911 Transition Order").

1. Deployment Challenges

- After five years of dedication to deploying NG911, RFA continues to bear the cost of supporting both legacy 911 and the NG911 network due to unresolved issues causing delays in advancements.
- As hard as we try to deploy IP-based NG911 services, unfortunately, we do not see an equivalent eagerness from some Originating Service Providers (“OSPs”) to partner in advancing the technologies.

2. Cost of Maintaining the Legacy 911 Network

- RFA and the South Carolina PSAPs continue to absorb costs for both legacy and NG911 networks when deployment of an IP network would result in a cost savings of *at minimum* \$1.4 annually.
- The rising, unregulated cost of TDM is having a direct impact on our budgets, with no technological benefits associated with maintaining this antiquated technology.
 - RFA respectfully requests that the Commission neither revise any proposed TDM discontinuance schedules nor allow for OSP extensions to use TDM for 911. Doing so will continue to place cost burdens on the State.
 - Those clinging to TDM have not demonstrated an operational benefit of doing so and yet continue to pass on price increases of this outdated technology to both RFA and the PSAPs.
 - Due to the tremendous hike in TDM rates, RFA further urges the Commission to swiftly mandate the NG911 NPRM’s proposed requirement for OSPs to deliver their customers’ traffic to 911 authority-designated POIs in an IP-based format.

3. Requests for Service

- The ex parte comments made by certain companies that recently met with the FCC indicate that multiple “Requests for Service” from governmental entities could burden OSPs and therefore more time may be needed for deployments of NG911. RFA stands firm on its belief and its experience that 6 months is adequate notice for OSPs to prepare for IP-based interconnection. If longer timeframes are truly needed by certain OSPs, RFA urges the FCC to leave any such determinations and negotiations to 911 authorities.
 - In general, rules establishing longer timeframes for OSP deployment will only continue to waste valuable state revenues and resources supporting old and outdated networks.
 - Requests for longer timeframes place 911 network reliability and redundancy at risk with the legacy networks.

4. Request for Regulatory Relief

The South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office is grateful to have the assistance of the Federal Communications Commissions in regulatory matters related to deployment of 9-1-1 services. RFA believes that FCC adoption of the proposed NG911 rules are absolutely critical to the future of 911 in the United States.

Accordingly, RFA respectfully requests the Commission to act swiftly enforce the rules adopted in the NG911 Transition Order.

Respectfully submitted,

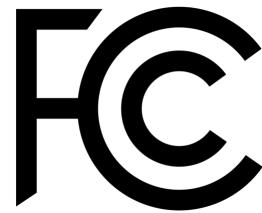
A handwritten signature in dark ink, appearing to read 'PA' followed by a stylized flourish.

Paul M. Athey

Attachment

South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office

Meeting with Federal Communications Commission



April 30, 2026



*South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office
1000 Assembly Street
Rembert Dennis Building, Suite 421
Columbia, SC 29201
(803) 734-3793
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AGENDA

- Introductions
- South Carolina NG911 System
- NG911 Transition Status



INTRODUCTIONS

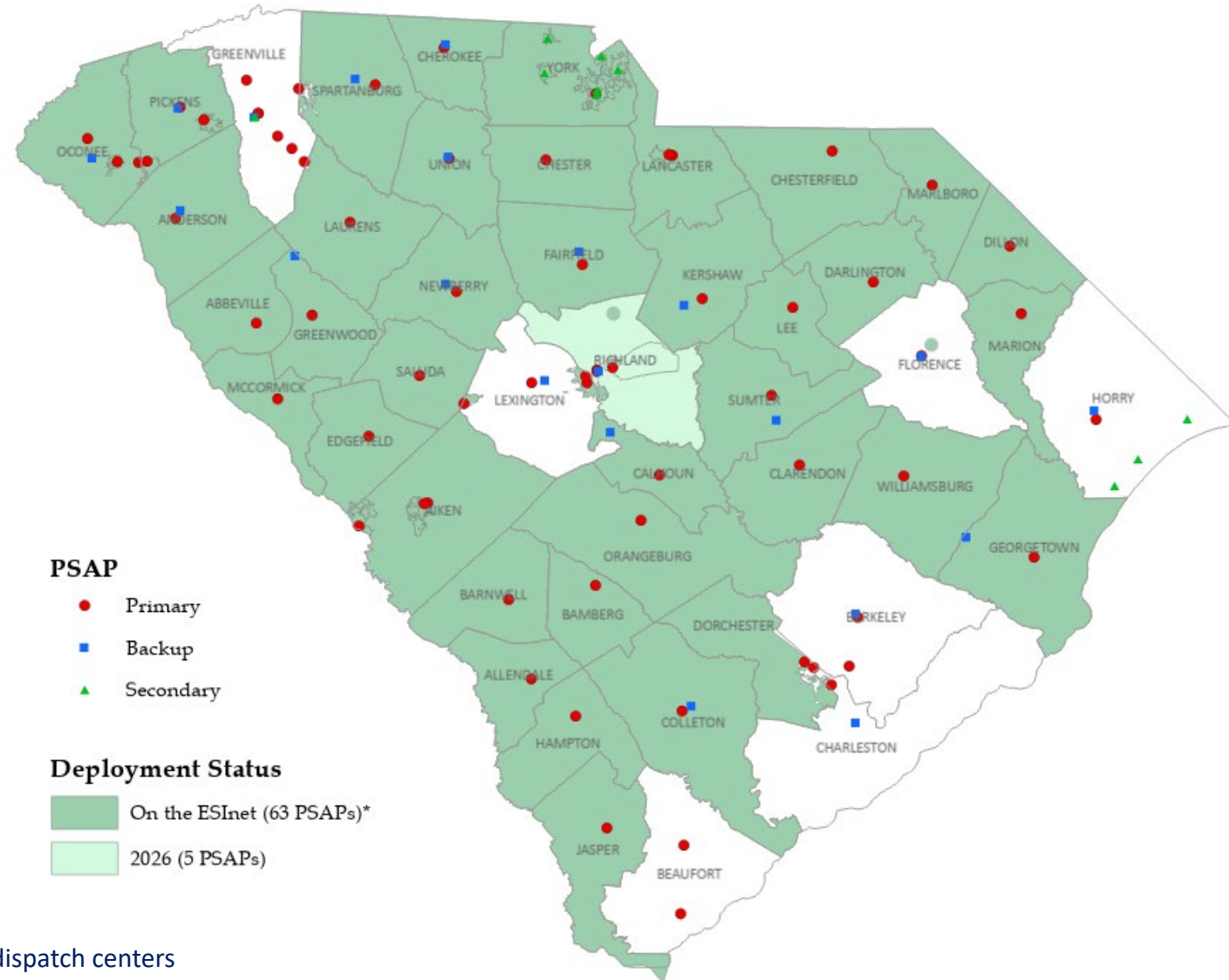
- Paul Athey, Division Director, SC Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office
- David Morrison, Program Manager, SC Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office
- Michael Ball, Project Manager, SC Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office
- Kasey Hamrick, Project Coordinator, SC Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office
- Susan Ornstein, Senior Director, Legal and Regulatory Affairs, Allerium

ABOUT SOUTH CAROLINA'S NG911 SYSTEM

- South Carolina Revenue and Fiscal Affairs Office (“RFA”), the state’s 911 authority, began deploying NG911 technology in 2021
 - Highly redundant, resilient network design
- NG911 network covers 63 PSAPs across the state, as well as 2 Highway Patrol dispatch centers



SC ESInet Migrations Through April 2026



*63 PSAPs plus 2 Highway Patrol dispatch centers

Current as of April 28, 2026

SOUTH CAROLINA PHASE 1 NG911 TRANSITION STATUS

- RFA filed a valid Phase 1 request on June 25, 2025
 - RFA filed an update on September 9, 2025, regarding South Carolina's addition of a third zip code/POI capable of receiving SIP traffic
- Deadline for Phase 1 compliance for nationwide wireless carriers, non-rural ILECs, and interconnected VoIP providers was December 25, 2025
- Deadline for rural carriers is June 25, 2026
- South Carolina has granted several requests by OSPs for extensions
 - Some OSPs have requested additional extensions

SOUTH CAROLINA PHASE 1 NG911 TRANSITION STATUS

- Until all carriers comply with NG911 Transition Phase 1 requirements, RFA and the PSAPs continue to bear the cost for both legacy and NG911 networks.
- TDM is antiquated technology, and the rising, unregulated cost of TDM continues to have a direct financial impact on state and local governments in South Carolina, taking funds away from other 911 services while providing no technological benefits.

Questions / Comments

Thank You!

For additional information please visit our website: www.rfa.sc.gov

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